OAVS TGT - Current Affairs

Part 5: INTERNATIONAL HAPPENINGS

Expected questions with answers & explanations
based on PYQ pattern analysis (2019, 2022, 2023, 2024)

International events roughly Sep 2025 - Oct 2026, plus static world GK. Facts verified as of 28 Oct 2026.

42 MCQs | 4 topics | star = very high probability

PYQ Pattern Analysis - International

Syllabus: *Current Affairs (30 marks) - recent developments in Sports, Awards, Politics, Finance & Banking, International happenings, etc.* Across the five papers analysed, international events contributed 3-6 questions per paper. The recurring question types are:

Question type	Typical example from PYQs	How to prepare
Visits & bilateral	Bhutan PM visit to India (Dec 2018); President Kovind in Croatia (Mar 2019)	Leaders visiting India and India's top-level trips
Elections abroad	Mueller Report (US election); Republican candidate 2024; Nepal PM committee	Who won/leads in the US, neighbours and big powers
Reports & indices	State of World Population 2019; State of Global Air 2020; SDG Report 2022; WHO Air Quality 2022	Top country and India's rank in each yearly report
International bodies	UN Panel of External Auditors vice-chair; WHO; ADB loans	UN, WHO, ADB, World Bank heads and decisions
Space & science	ISRO hyperspectral satellite (Nov 2018); GARUDA grid	Latest ISRO/NASA missions and dates

Strategy: most questions ask who led/hosted/won something abroad, or which report ranks which country. Prioritise starred questions and the Rapid-Revision table at the end.

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1. Summits, Groupings & Global Bodies

Why it matters: PYQs asked about visiting leaders and presidential trips (Bhutan PM visit 2018, President Kovind's Croatia visit 2019), UN panels and summit outcomes. Learn the host, theme, outcome and next host of every major summit.

KEY FACTS

• 18th BRICS Summit: 12-13 Sep 2026, Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi; theme 'Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability'. India chaired BRICS in 2026 (from 1 Jan, succeeding Brazil). The 140-paragraph New Delhi Declaration condemned the Pahalgam attack and unilateral tariffs, backed UN reform and a WTO-centred trading system, and created no common BRICS currency. Xi Jinping made his first India visit in seven years; Putin also attended. China chairs BRICS in 2027.

• G20 Summit, Johannesburg (22-23 Nov 2025): first G20 summit in Africa (South Africa's presidency; Ramaphosa host). The US boycotted; leaders adopted the declaration without US input. The US hosts the next G20 in 2026 (Florida).

• COP30, Belem (Brazil), ended 22 Nov 2025 (President Andre Correa do Lago): final deal called for tripling adaptation finance by 2035 but stopped short of a commitment to phase out fossil fuels. COP31 (Nov 2026): hosted by Turkey, with Australia leading negotiations.

• UN Secretary-General selection 2026: Antonio Guterres's term ends 31 Dec 2026; successor takes office 1 Jan 2027. Sixth Security Council straw poll held 16 Oct 2026; seven candidates remain - Rafael Grossi (Argentina, IAEA), Rebeca Grynspan (Costa Rica, UNCTAD), Macky Sall (Senegal), Maria Fernanda Espinosa and Ivonne A-Baki (Ecuador), Olara Otunnu (Uganda), Carolyn Rodrigues-Birkett (Guyana). A candidate needs 9 'encourage' votes and no veto from the five permanent members.

• India-EU Summit, New Delhi (27 Jan 2026): free trade agreement concluded ('mother of all deals' - Ursula von der Leyen), 'Towards 2030' joint agenda and a Security & Defence Partnership signed; EU leaders: von der Leyen (Commission) and Antonio Costa (Council).

Practice questions

Q1. ★ The 18th BRICS Summit (September 2026) was held in:

(A) Brasilia
(B) Johannesburg
(C) Moscow
(D) New Delhi

Answer: (D) New Delhi. Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi, 12-13 September 2026 - India chaired BRICS in 2026.

Q2. Which declaration was adopted at the 18th BRICS Summit?

(A) Rio Declaration
(B) Kazan Declaration
(C) New Delhi Declaration
(D) Johannesburg Declaration

Answer: (C) New Delhi Declaration. The 140-paragraph New Delhi Declaration.

Q3. Which country chairs BRICS in 2027, after India?

(A) China
(B) Brazil
(C) Russia
(D) South Africa

Answer: (A) China. China - the 19th summit is expected there.

Q4. ★ Which world leader visited India in September 2026 for the first time in seven years and met PM Modi on the BRICS sidelines?

(A) Lula da Silva
(B) Vladimir Putin
(C) Masoud Pezeshkian
(D) Xi Jinping

Answer: (D) Xi Jinping. Chinese President Xi Jinping.

Q5. ★ The 2025 G20 Summit held in Johannesburg was the first G20 summit in:

(A) Oceania
(B) Africa
(C) Asia
(D) South America

Answer: (B) Africa. The first G20 summit on African soil (22-23 Nov 2025).

Q6. Which major country boycotted the G20 Summit in Johannesburg in November 2025?

(A) United States
(B) Russia
(C) Japan
(D) China

Answer: (A) United States. The US skipped it; the declaration was adopted without US input.

Q7. Which country hosts the G20 Summit in 2026?

(A) India
(B) United States
(C) Brazil
(D) Turkey

Answer: (B) United States. The United States (Florida).

Q8. ★ COP30 (UN climate conference, November 2025) was held in:

(A) Glasgow
(B) Belem
(C) Dubai
(D) Baku

Answer: (B) Belem. Belem, Brazil. COP29 was in Baku; COP28 in Dubai.

Q9. COP31 (November 2026) is being hosted by:

(A) India
(B) Turkey
(C) Egypt
(D) Australia

Answer: (B) Turkey. Turkey hosts; Australia leads the negotiations (a compromise).

Q10. The COP30 final outcome called for tripling of which finance by 2035?

(A) Mitigation finance
(B) Loss-and-damage fund
(C) Adaptation finance
(D) Technology transfer fund

Answer: (C) Adaptation finance. Adaptation finance - but no fossil-fuel phase-out commitment.

Q11. The term of UN Secretary-General Antonio Guterres ends on:

(A) 30 June 2026
(B) 31 December 2026
(C) 31 March 2027
(D) 31 December 2027

Answer: (B) 31 December 2026. His successor takes office on 1 January 2027.

Q12. Which of the following is a candidate for UN Secretary-General in 2026 and heads the IAEA?

(A) Rafael Grossi
(B) Macky Sall
(C) Rebeca Grynspan
(D) Olara Otunnu

Answer: (A) Rafael Grossi. Rafael Grossi (Argentina), Director General of the IAEA. Grynspan heads UNCTAD.

Q13. ★ In January 2026, India and the European Union concluded negotiations on a:

(A) Visa-free regime
(B) Currency swap
(C) Free trade agreement
(D) Defence treaty only

Answer: (C) Free trade agreement. The India-EU FTA, announced at the 27 Jan 2026 summit in New Delhi.

2. World Leaders & Elections

Why it matters: The PYQs asked 'Prime Minister who visited India', 'Republican candidate for the 2024 US election' and Nepal PM news. Neighbouring-country leaders and big-power changes are the favourite targets.

KEY FACTS

• Bangladesh (Feb 2026): BNP won a landslide in the national election (BNP-led alliance 212 seats; Jamaat-led alliance 77; Awami League barred). Tarique Rahman (BNP chairman, son of Khaleda Zia and Ziaur Rahman) sworn in as Prime Minister on 17 Feb 2026 by President Mohammed Shahabuddin. Muhammad Yunus led the interim government before.

• Nepal (Mar 2026): after the Gen Z-led uprising (Sept 2025) toppled KP Sharma Oli, Rastriya Swatantra Party (RSP) swept the election (125 of 165 first-past-the-post seats). Rapper-turned-politician Balendra 'Balen' Shah (ex-Kathmandu mayor) sworn in as PM in late March 2026 by President Ram Chandra Paudel.

• Japan: Sanae Takaichi became Japan's first woman Prime Minister (Oct 2025); the LDP won a two-thirds majority in the snap election of 8 Feb 2026; she was reappointed on 18 Feb 2026.

• Venezuela: on 3 Jan 2026 US forces carried out strikes on Caracas and captured President Nicolas Maduro and his wife Cilia Flores; Maduro faces narco-terrorism charges in New York. US President: Donald Trump (second term, from Jan 2025).

• Other office-holders: UK PM Keir Starmer; German Chancellor Friedrich Merz; Canadian PM Mark Carney; Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian; EU Commission President Ursula von der Leyen; IOC president Kirsty Coventry.

Practice questions

Q14. ★ Who became Bangladesh's Prime Minister in February 2026 after a landslide election win?

(A) Tarique Rahman
(B) Sheikh Hasina
(C) Muhammad Yunus
(D) Shafiqur Rahman

Answer: (A) Tarique Rahman. BNP chairman Tarique Rahman, sworn in 17 Feb 2026.

Q15. Tarique Rahman, Bangladesh's PM, is the son of former PM Khaleda Zia and assassinated President:

(A) Mujibur Rahman
(B) Hussain Muhammad Ershad
(C) Ziaur Rahman
(D) Abdus Sattar

Answer: (C) Ziaur Rahman. Ziaur Rahman, founder of the BNP.

Q16. Which party was barred from contesting the February 2026 Bangladesh election?

(A) Jatiya Party
(B) BNP
(C) Jamaat-e-Islami
(D) Awami League

Answer: (D) Awami League. The Election Commission revoked the Awami League's registration.

Q17. Who led Bangladesh's interim government before the February 2026 election?

(A) Muhammad Yunus
(B) Khaleda Zia
(C) Tarique Rahman
(D) Abdul Hamid

Answer: (A) Muhammad Yunus. Nobel laureate Muhammad Yunus.

Q18. ★ Who became Nepal's Prime Minister in March 2026 after his party's landslide win?

(A) Balendra (Balen) Shah
(B) Sher Bahadur Deuba
(C) Pushpa Kamal Dahal
(D) KP Sharma Oli

Answer: (A) Balendra (Balen) Shah. Rapper-turned-politician Balen Shah of the Rastriya Swatantra Party.

Q19. Which Nepali leader was toppled by the Gen Z-led uprising of September 2025?

(A) Pushpa Kamal Dahal
(B) Sher Bahadur Deuba
(C) Baburam Bhattarai
(D) KP Sharma Oli

Answer: (D) KP Sharma Oli. KP Sharma Oli resigned after the protests over corruption and a social-media ban.

Q20. ★ Who is Japan's first woman Prime Minister (since October 2025)?

(A) Mitsuko Shimomura
(B) Seiko Hashimoto
(C) Yuriko Koike
(D) Sanae Takaichi

Answer: (D) Sanae Takaichi. Sanae Takaichi; her LDP won a two-thirds majority in the 8 Feb 2026 snap election.

Q21. ★ Which Venezuelan leader was captured by US forces on 3 January 2026?

(A) Nicolas Maduro
(B) Hugo Chavez
(C) Delcy Rodriguez
(D) Juan Guaido

Answer: (A) Nicolas Maduro. Nicolas Maduro and his wife Cilia Flores; charged with narco-terrorism in New York.

Q22. The Prime Minister of Canada is:

(A) Mark Carney
(B) Pierre Poilievre
(C) Justin Trudeau
(D) Jagmeet Singh

Answer: (A) Mark Carney. Mark Carney (since March 2025).

Q23. Who is the Chancellor of Germany?

(A) Robert Habeck
(B) Olaf Scholz
(C) Angela Merkel
(D) Friedrich Merz

Answer: (D) Friedrich Merz. Friedrich Merz (CDU), since May 2025.

3. Conflicts, Peace Efforts & India's Diplomacy

Why it matters: International news in the exam often combines a conflict with an Indian angle (trade deals, tariffs, visits). Learn the key peace-plan names and the India-US and India-EU deals.

KEY FACTS

• Gaza: a ceasefire took effect in October 2025 under US President Trump's 20-Point Peace Plan. On 16 Jan 2026 Trump announced the 'Board of Peace' to administer Gaza (with Egypt, Turkey and Qatar as mediators); Bulgarian diplomat Nickolay Mladenov is expected to be director; a Palestinian technocratic committee manages day-to-day affairs. Hamas disarmament remains the sticking point.

• Russia-Ukraine: peace talks have stalled since early 2026; US-mediated trilateral talks (Russia-Ukraine-US) are planned in Abu Dhabi in the first half of November 2026 (around 10 Nov). US special envoy: Steve Witkoff.

• India-US trade: on 2 Feb 2026 Trump announced a trade deal after speaking to PM Modi - US tariff on India cut to 18% (a 25% penalty for Russian-oil purchases, imposed in Aug 2025, was removed); India to cut tariffs/non-tariff barriers and buy more US energy, technology and farm goods; a framework for an interim trade agreement was released on 7 Feb 2026.

• India-EU: FTA concluded at the 27 Jan 2026 summit in New Delhi (EU leaders Ursula von der Leyen and Antonio Costa), a security and defence partnership signed, and an 'India-EU Towards 2030' joint agenda adopted; investment protection and GI agreements still pending.

• PYQ anchors: Bhutan PM visited India (Dec 2018); President Kovind visited Croatia (Mar 2019); Mueller Report - US presidential election; Nepal PM formed a committee (Sep 2021).

Practice questions

Q24. ★ Which body was announced in January 2026 to administer the Gaza Strip under Trump's peace plan?

(A) Board of Peace
(B) Arab League Council
(C) UN Peacekeeping Force
(D) NATO Gaza Mission

Answer: (A) Board of Peace. The 'Board of Peace' - the next phase of the 20-Point Peace Plan.

Q25. The Gaza ceasefire of October 2025 was brokered under US President Trump's:

(A) Abraham Accords
(B) 10-Point Plan
(C) 20-Point Peace Plan
(D) Oslo II Plan

Answer: (C) 20-Point Peace Plan. The 20-Point Peace Plan; mediators included Egypt, Qatar and Turkey.

Q26. Which Bulgarian diplomat is expected to serve as director of the Gaza 'Board of Peace'?

(A) Tony Blair
(B) Jared Kushner
(C) Antonio Guterres
(D) Nickolay Mladenov

Answer: (D) Nickolay Mladenov. Nickolay Mladenov, former UN Special Coordinator for the Middle East peace process.

Q27. Where are US-mediated Russia-Ukraine talks planned for November 2026?

(A) Istanbul
(B) Riyadh
(C) Geneva
(D) Abu Dhabi

Answer: (D) Abu Dhabi. Abu Dhabi (UAE) - a trilateral format announced by the Kremlin on 23 Oct 2026.

Q28. Who is the US special envoy leading peace diplomacy on the Russia-Ukraine war?

(A) Jared Kushner
(B) Marco Rubio
(C) Steve Witkoff
(D) Mike Pompeo

Answer: (C) Steve Witkoff. Steve Witkoff.

Q29. ★ In February 2026, the US cut its tariff on Indian goods to:

(A) 25%
(B) 18%
(C) 15%
(D) 10%

Answer: (B) 18%. 18% - announced by Trump on 2 Feb 2026 after a call with PM Modi.

Q30. The 2025 penalty tariff imposed on India by the US was linked to India's purchase of:

(A) Russian oil
(B) Saudi oil
(C) Iranian oil
(D) Venezuelan oil

Answer: (A) Russian oil. A 25% penalty for buying discounted Russian oil, imposed in August 2025.

Q31. ★ The India-EU Free Trade Agreement was announced at a summit held in:

(A) Brussels
(B) Berlin
(C) Paris
(D) New Delhi

Answer: (D) New Delhi. New Delhi, 27 January 2026.

Q32. Which of the following was signed at the India-EU Summit in January 2026?

(A) A Security and Defence Partnership
(B) A nuclear fuel treaty
(C) A joint space station deal
(D) A currency union

Answer: (A) A Security and Defence Partnership. Along with the 'Towards 2030' joint agenda; the investment protection pact is still pending.

Q33. ★ Which country's presidential election was the subject of the Mueller Report (asked in OAVS TGT English 2019)?

(A) Russia
(B) USA
(C) Brazil
(D) France

Answer: (B) USA. The 2016 US presidential election.

4. Space, Reports & Global Indices

Why it matters: The PYQs asked about reports and indices (State of World Population 2019, State of Global Air 2020, SDG Report 2022, WHO Air Quality) and ISRO launches. Learn the number-one country and India's rank for each.

KEY FACTS

• NASA's Artemis II: crewed 10-day mission around the Moon; splashed down in the Pacific off California on 11 Apr 2026 - first humans near the Moon in over 50 years. A crewed lunar landing is planned for 2028.

• ISRO's Gaganyaan (India's first human spaceflight) is expected in 2027; Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla flew to the ISS on Axiom-4 in 2025.

• World Happiness Report 2026 (released 20 Mar 2026, International Day of Happiness): 1 Finland, 2 Iceland, 3 Denmark, 4 Costa Rica, 5 Sweden. India 116th (up from 118th); Nepal 99, Pakistan 104, Bangladesh 127, Sri Lanka 134, Afghanistan 147 (last).

• PYQ anchors: WHO Air Quality Database 2022 - 99% of the world's population breathes air above WHO limits; the 2019 and 2020 papers asked about the State of World Population (UNFPA) and State of Global Air (HEI) reports; ISRO launched the HySIS hyperspectral imaging satellite in Nov 2018.

Practice questions

Q34. ★ NASA's Artemis II mission, completed in April 2026, was a crewed mission around the:

(A) Moon
(B) Venus
(C) Jupiter
(D) Mars

Answer: (A) Moon. A 10-day lunar flyby; splashdown on 11 April 2026.

Q35. Artemis II splashed down in which ocean?

(A) Arctic
(B) Pacific
(C) Indian
(D) Atlantic

Answer: (B) Pacific. The Pacific, off the coast of California.

Q36. India's first human spaceflight mission is:

(A) Mangalyaan-2
(B) Chandrayaan-4
(C) Gaganyaan
(D) Aditya-L1

Answer: (C) Gaganyaan. Gaganyaan, expected in 2027.

Q37. Which Indian astronaut visited the International Space Station in 2025 on Axiom-4?

(A) Ajit Krishnan
(B) Prasanth Nair
(C) Rakesh Sharma
(D) Shubhanshu Shukla

Answer: (D) Shubhanshu Shukla. Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla.

Q38. ★ Which country ranks first in the World Happiness Report 2026?

(A) Finland
(B) Norway
(C) Iceland
(D) Denmark

Answer: (A) Finland. Finland (7.764), then Iceland and Denmark.

Q39. ★ India's rank in the World Happiness Report 2026 is:

(A) 126th
(B) 118th
(C) 116th
(D) 108th

Answer: (C) 116th. 116th (score 4.536), up from 118th in 2025.

Q40. The World Happiness Report is released every year on International Day of Happiness, which is:

(A) 10 December
(B) 5 June
(C) 21 June
(D) 20 March
Answer: (D) 20 March. 20 March.

Q41. Which country is ranked last (147th) in the World Happiness Report 2026?

(A) Afghanistan
(B) Yemen
(C) Lebanon
(D) Sierra Leone
Answer: (A) Afghanistan. Afghanistan.

Q42. The State of World Population report is published by:

(A) UNFPA
(B) World Bank
(C) UNICEF
(D) WHO
Answer: (A) UNFPA. UNFPA, the UN sexual and reproductive health agency (the 2019 paper asked about this report).

5. Rapid-Revision Table

Event	Answer
18th BRICS Summit	**New Delhi, 12-13 Sep 2026; New Delhi Declaration; China chairs 2027**
G20 2025 / 2026	**Johannesburg (first in Africa; US boycott) / United States**
COP30 / COP31	**Belem, Brazil (Nov 2025) / Turkey, Australia leads talks (Nov 2026)**
UN Secretary-General	**Guterres's term ends 31 Dec 2026; successor from 1 Jan 2027; 7 candidates**
India-EU FTA	**Concluded 27 Jan 2026, New Delhi; Security & Defence Partnership**
India-US trade deal	**2 Feb 2026 - tariff cut to 18%; framework for interim pact 7 Feb**
Bangladesh PM	**Tarique Rahman (BNP) - sworn 17 Feb 2026**
Nepal PM	**Balendra (Balen) Shah (RSP) - March 2026**
Japan PM	**Sanae Takaichi - first woman PM; LDP two-thirds (8 Feb 2026)**
Venezuela	**Maduro captured by US forces on 3 Jan 2026**
Gaza	**Ceasefire Oct 2025 (20-point plan); Board of Peace (Jan 2026)**
Russia-Ukraine	**US-mediated trilateral talks planned, Abu Dhabi, Nov 2026**
Artemis II	**10-day crewed lunar flyby; splashdown 11 Apr 2026**
World Happiness Report 2026	**Finland 1st; India 116th; Afghanistan 147th (last)**

Check before exam: the Russia-Ukraine talks (Nov 2026), ongoing events such as the UN Secretary-General race, COP31 and the US-hosted G20 will have outcomes after 28 Oct 2026 - re-check them close to the exam.

Sources

• Wikipedia (18th BRICS summit), Angel One, Vajiram & Ravi - BRICS 2026
• Dawn, Africanews, Citizen Digital - G20 Johannesburg 2025; The National - COP30; The Star, News24 - COP31
• CGTN, CTV News, Peninsula Qatar - UN Secretary-General selection 2026
• Business Today, The Week, Morung Express - India-EU summit and FTA; Scroll.in, ROIC - India-US trade deal
• Dawn, Aaj TV, The Quint - Bangladesh election and PM; Aaj TV, Financial Express - Nepal PM Balen Shah; Adda247 - Japan PM Takaichi
• ROIC, WLRN, Deccan Chronicle - Venezuela and Maduro; Irish Times, Al-Monitor - Gaza Board of Peace; Africanews - Russia-Ukraine talks
• ThePrint - Artemis II; India TV, Telangana Today, Drishti IAS - World Happiness Report 2026